From engineer to supervisory board member

The Women of TUM is a vibrant network that is growing rapidly and connects women at TUM. More than 11,000 alumnae, professors and students exchange ideas through the network, supporting, inspiring and encouraging each other. TUM Community events such as webinars, seminars and the Women of TUM Talks provide a regular platform for women and make them visible as role models. Four TUM Alumnae share what drives them forward in their careers.

Perseverance and determination

Aerospace Engineer
Maria Grulich

"It is clear to me that sooner or later I want to travel into space as an astronaut. I designed my studies and all subsequent professional steps with this big goal in mind. At TUM, I aquired the necessary stamina to consistently pursue my path. I never give up."

Maria Grulich moved from Hanover to Munich to study Aerospace Engineering. She spent her semester abroad in Toulouse, and wrote her Master's thesis in the USA in Florida. While still a student, she developed a rocket experiment that flew into the thermosphere. In the Utah desert, she was part of a simulated Mars mission twice. Since 2018, Maria Grulich has been working at DLR's Microgravity User Support Center in Cologne for ESA's Columbus Space Laboratory.

More about Maria Grulich: *www.community.tum.de/en/maria-grulich*

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TUM TIP

Looking for more role models? TUM Alumni from all over the world share their life and stories at *www.community.tum.de/stories*

International experience

Top Manager
Dr. Elisabetta Castiglioni

"I have lived and worked in four different countries. This has broadened my horizons and opened my mind. I have learned to take different perspectives and allow for different possibilities. Depending on the requirements, I draw the appropriate impulses from my cultural and professional experiences. In this way, I can make better decisions today."

At a time when this was still unusual, Elisabetta Castiglioni went to Germany alone to study Business Administration at Ludwig-Maximilians-University in Munich. She then went on to earn her PhD at TUM. Since then, she has enjoyed an unparalleled career in top management at major companies in the technology, media and telecommunications industries. She is considered an expert in digitalization. Since 2017, she has been Managing Director and CEO of Telekom Austria Group subsidiary A1 Digital. She is also a member of the Supervisory Board of A1 Telekom Austria AG as well as of LEONI AG and a member of the Board of Directors of Euskaltel S. A.

More about Dr. Elisabetta Castiglioni: *www.community.tum.de/en/elisabetta-castiglioni*

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Work-life balance

Molecular Geneticist and TUM Ambassador
Prof. Dr. Maya Schuldiner

"Over the years I have realized that I can do much better science when I am happy and full of energy. This happiness lies in being able to have enough time for my partner, children, friends and hobbies in addition to my work."

In 1998, Maya Schuldiner graduated in Israel with a Bachelor's Degree in Biology. In 1999, she followed with a Master's degree in Genetics. In 2003, she earned her PhD in Genetics. For her postdoctoral studies, she went to San Francisco, USA. Since 2008, she has been conducting research at the Department of Molecular Genetics at the Weizmann Institute of Science in Rehovot, Israel. Since 2019 she holds the Dr. Gilbert Omenn and Martha Darling Chair in Molecular Genetics. In 2020, Maya Schuldiner was awarded the honorary title of TUM Ambassador by TUM President Thomas F. Hofmann. She is a good example that a remarkable scientific career does not have to mean giving up a rich private and family life. Naturally, she shares parenting duties for her three children with her husband and fellow scientist, Oren Schuldiner.

More about Maya Schuldiner: *www.community.tum.de/en/schuldiner-maya*

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Leaving the comfort zone of your discipline

Marine Biologist and Human Geoprapher
María José Barragán-Paladines

"Studying at TUM taught me that superficially independent topics are actually very closely related. It was only through this image that I was able to see the Big Picture and realized how incomplete and inaccurate my previous approaches had been. Since then, I have pursued a decidedly inter- and transdisciplinary career. Only by being open to the diverse insights beyond my own discipline, I can find answers to the complex issues surrounding the conservation and sustainable optionsfor the Galapagos Islands."

María José Barragán-Paladines completed a Bachelor's degree in Biology in Ecuador and a Master's degree in Sustainable Resource Management at TUM. She went to Canada for her PhD in Human Geography. Since 2018, she is the Scientific Director of the Charles Darwin Foundation for the Galapagos Islands.

More about María José Barragán-Paladines: *www.community.tum.de/en/maria-jose-barragan-paladines*

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